Glossary

furnace (n) – an enclosed structure in which material is heated to very high temperatures

wrought (adj.) – beaten out of shape by hammering

gauged (v) – estimated

thousandth (adv.) – a fraction of thousand

haul (v) – pull or drag with effort or force

comprehend(v) – grasp, understand

vanish(v) – disappear suddenly and completely

A. Answer the following questions briefly.

1. Who does 'we' refer to in first stanza?

a. Human beings b. Machines

2. Who are the speakers and listeners of this poem?
3. What metals are obtained from ores and mines?
4. Mention a few machines which are hammered to design.
5. Mention the names of a few machines that run on water, coal or oil.
6. Mention a few machines used for pulling, pushing, lifting, driving, printing, ploughing, reading, writing etc.
7. Are machines humble to accept the evolution of human brain? Why?
8. What feelings are evoked in us by the machines in this poem?
9. ***And a thousandth of an inch to give us play:***
   Which of the following do the machines want to prove from this line?
   a. Once Machines are fed with fuel, they take a very long time to start.
   b. Once Machines are fed with fuel, they start quickly.
10. ***And now, if you will set us to our task,***
    We will serve you four and twenty hours a day!
    a. Who does the pronoun 'you' refer to here?
    b. Whose task is referred to as 'our task' here?
    c. Open conditional clause is used in the given line. Why is the future tense 'will set' and 'will serve' used both in the 'if clause' and in the 'main clause?'
    d. Do the machines serve us twenty four hours a day?
    e. Rewrite the given lines with the ending '365 days a year.'

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